

MCEPTION.AI INNOVATION WORKSHOP

Stream of Consciousness

20 product ideas across 6 raw seeds

Run 3 — April 15, 2026

GENERATED BY BRADY OS • SEED-FIRST IDEATION

BRADY'S 6 SEEDS

1. Women's clothes with a TON of pockets — but looks good
2. Sourdough bread meets current health / flavor / food trends
3. Dry sourdough starter
4. 15-pound lasagna — actual family-size meals, affordable
5. Fudge ripple cake
6. Southern cuisine turned mainstream

This workshop inverts the usual process. Instead of picking lanes and running methods to generate ideas, Brady walked in with six raw product seeds — things he's been thinking about — and we expanded each into 3–4 product variations using proven ideation methods. No blending across seeds. Each idea stands on its own. The result: 20 products spanning fashion, fermentation, family meals, nostalgic desserts, and Southern cuisine — the widest category spread of any workshop run to date.

6

Raw Seeds

Brady's stream of consciousness

24

Ideas Generated

4 per seed avg

20

Survivors

83% survival rate

5

Category Lanes

First non-food lane (fashion)



1.

Instant Sourdough Starter Sachets

Single-use packets that eliminate the intimidation barrier. Add water, wait 24 hours, bake. The "sourdough for normal people" play.



2.

Famous Bakery Cultures

Heritage starter strains from legendary bakeries worldwide. Collectible, provenance-driven. Bake with a 150-year-old culture.



3.

Craft Pimento Cheese

Premium refrigerated pimento cheese with real sharp cheddar. National distribution of a Southern regional staple. Four varieties.



4.

The Pocket Dress

Sleek event-ready dress with 12+ invisible pockets. Fashion-forward solution to the "women's clothes have no pockets" problem.



5.

The REAL Family Size Lasagna

15-lb catering-pan lasagna. Stouffer's biggest is 5.6 lbs. This feeds 10–12 for \$24.99. Finally, a "family size" that's actually family size.

The Accessibility Gap

Multiple ideas attack the same pattern: something that exists in premium/niche form but hasn't been made accessible. Sourdough starters, heritage grains, pimento cheese, Southern pantry staples — all regionally or culturally locked.

Format Over Formula

The winning move isn't inventing new food — it's putting existing food in new formats. Sachets, catering pans, snack crisps, cake mixes with real ingredients. Same product, new container, new occasion.

Solving Actual Problems

The fashion ideas aren't "fashion for fashion's sake." Women literally don't have pockets. Families literally can't find meals that feed 8+. These ideas solve real, daily friction points.

Women’s Clothes with Pockets

Fashion meets function. The pocket gap in women's clothing is a documented frustration with real market demand — cargo-style and multi-pocket accessories are dominating Gen Z fashion through 2026. Budget casual dresses with pockets see 8,000–15,000 weekly unit sales on Amazon.

The Pocket Dress

FASHION

HIGH IMPACT

JTBD

SCORE

3.95



The Pitch

A sleek, event-ready women's dress with 12+ invisible pockets. Phone in the left panel. Keys in the right seam. Wallet in the interior lining. Lipstick in the concealed zip at the waist. From the outside, it looks like any other elegant midi dress — navy, structured, flattering. From the inside, it's an engineering project.

The job-to-be-done is dead simple: go out without a purse and still carry everything you need. Every woman who's ever shoved her phone into her waistband or asked her partner to hold her stuff understands this product instantly. The TikTok #pocketgate movement — where women compare the size of their jean pockets to men's — proves the frustration is real and viral.

Price it at \$89-129 for the hero dress. Expand into blazers, jumpsuits, and joggers once the brand is established. This isn't tactical wear repackaged — it's fashion-first design that happens to solve a

genuine daily problem.

Reasons to Believe

- Budget casual dresses with pockets see 8,000-15,000 weekly unit sales on Amazon, with PRETTYGARDEN and ANRABESS dominating. Premium tier (\$89+) is wide open.
- Cargo-style and multi-pocket accessories will dominate through 2026, driven by Gen Z's preference for practical fashion (Trendalytics).
- "Guardian design" — enriching familiar items with smart, solution-led details like hidden pockets and anti-slash materials — is an emerging macro trend.
- The U.S. women's clothing market exceeds \$190B. Functional fashion is the fastest-growing subsegment.

Competitive Landscape

PRETTYGARDEN / ANRABESS: Budget Amazon dresses (\$18-28) with basic pockets. No fashion cachet. High volume, low margin.

Anatomie: Travel-focused women's clothing with hidden pockets. Premium (\$150+) but positioned as travel/utility, not fashion.

Gap: No brand owns "fashionable pockets" as a core identity. The market has budget commodity (Amazon) and travel utility (Anatomie) but nothing in the fashion-forward middle.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Pocket engineering requires custom pattern-making — standard cut-and-sew won't work. Need a garment engineer who understands weight distribution (12 pockets with items creates sag if not engineered properly).

MOQ for custom patterns: 200-500 units per style. Fabric sourcing is standard. Can use existing fashion supply chain (Vietnam, Portugal) with custom specs.

EFFORT

Medium

Custom patterns needed

IMPACT

High

Viral potential

METHOD

#4 JTBD

Jobs to Be Done

Carry Everything Blazer

FASHION

PROFESSIONAL

SCAMPER

SCORE

3.65



The Pitch

A tailored women's blazer in charcoal or navy with 14 internal pockets — phone, wallet, keys, lipstick, pen, glasses, business cards, earbuds, passport, and more. Every pocket is invisible from the outside. The blazer looks like any other sharp, well-cut professional piece.

The target is the professional woman who carries a bag because she has to, not because she wants to. Think: the commuter who juggles a laptop bag AND a purse. The conference attendee who needs hands free for handshakes but still needs her phone accessible. The traveler who wants her passport secure without a crossbody.

Reasons to Believe

- Men's blazers from brands like SCOTTeVEST have proven the "many pockets" concept works — but they look like dad-tech. No one has done this with women's fashion-forward tailoring.
- The women's workwear market is \$38.4B globally and growing at 5.2% CAGR.
- Post-pandemic hybrid work has increased demand for versatile pieces that transition from office to dinner.

Competitive Landscape

SCOTTeVEST: The OG multi-pocket brand. 20+ pockets in jackets. But it's ugly. Tech-bro aesthetic, not fashion.

Argent: Women's workwear brand. Quality tailoring but no pocket innovation.

Gap: Nobody combines serious tailoring with serious pocket engineering for women.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Same engineering challenge as the dress but blazer construction is more forgiving — structured shoulders and lining hide pocket bulk. Higher price point (\$149–199) supports the engineering cost.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#21

SCAMPER

Mom’s Tactical Joggers

- FASHION
- DAD/FAMILY
- JTBD



The Pitch

Athleisure joggers with 8 hidden pockets designed for the "mom carry" — phone, snack bar, wipes, keys, cards, lip balm, hair ties, and a pacifier. Looks like Lululemon. Works like cargo pants. Priced at \$68–85.

Every mom at school pickup, the playground, or Target knows this frustration: you need both hands, you need ten things accessible, and you don't want to look like you're wearing tactical gear. These joggers solve the "diaper bag is too much but pockets aren't enough" gap. The olive green, black, and heather gray colorways are intentionally basic — these are everyday pants, not statement pieces.

Reasons to Believe

- The athleisure market hit \$407B in 2025 and is growing at 8.6% CAGR. Joggers are the category's anchor product.
- "Mom carry" content on TikTok — where mothers show what they carry daily — has 2.1B cumulative views. The need is documented and viral.
- Lululemon's women's joggers retail at \$98–128 with 2 pockets. Adding 6 more pockets at \$68–85 is a value play with differentiation.

Competitive Landscape

- Lululemon:** Premium joggers, 2 pockets. No pocket innovation.
- Athleta:** Similar — quality fabric, basic pockets.
- Amazon basics:** Cheap joggers with cargo pockets. Not fashionable.
- Gap:** No one makes athleisure joggers specifically designed for the mom carry with hidden pocket engineering.

Operational Complexity

- SIMPLE
- Jogger construction is simpler than tailored blazers. Stretch fabric forgives pocket bulk. Can co-pack with existing athleisure manufacturers. MOQ: 300–500 units.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#4 JTBD

Jobs to Be Done

The Pocketgate Collection

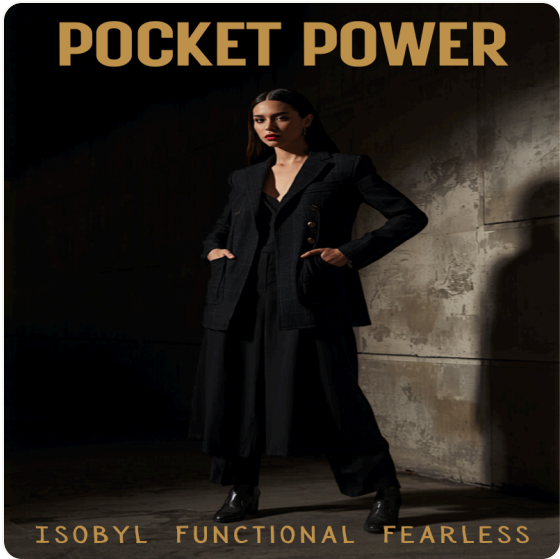
FASHION

TIKTOK-NATIVE

CULTURAL TREND

SCORE

3.85



The Pitch

While the other pocket products hide their pockets, this one makes them the star. A capsule collection where pockets ARE the visible design element — gold zippers, structured pocket silhouettes, oversized utility flaps treated as fashion statements. This is the brand that turns #pocketgate from a complaint into a movement.

Think streetwear-meets-high-fashion. Four pieces per drop, released quarterly. Limited runs. The brand identity is built around the cultural frustration itself — every campaign is a direct callout of the pocket inequality. TikTok-native marketing, UGC-driven, zero traditional advertising budget.

Reasons to Believe

- TikTok and Instagram Reels.
- #pocketgate and pocket comparison content consistently goes viral — millions of views across
- Drop culture in fashion (Supreme, Corteiz) proves limited releases drive urgency and brand loyalty.
- DTC fashion brands with strong cultural narratives (Girlfriend Collective, Pangaia) have achieved \$100M+ valuations.

Competitive Landscape

No direct competitor. No fashion brand has built its entire identity around the pocket inequality narrative. This is pure whitespace — a brand built on a meme with real substance.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Small batch production (200–500 per drop). Higher per-unit cost but premium pricing (\$120–200) supports it. Gold hardware sourcing adds complexity.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#51

Cultural Trend Mining

Sourdough Meets Health & Flavor Trends

The global sourdough market is projected at \$5.9B in 2025, growing at 6.8–9.9% CAGR. 58% of consumers believe sourdough makes bread healthier. Bakery launches with digestive–health claims grew 22% globally. Sourdough is no longer artisan–only — it's going mass–market.

Heritage Grain Sourdough

3.85

- CPG
- PREMIUMIZATION
- PROVENANCE



The Pitch

Single-origin, heritage grain sourdough with a provenance story on every loaf. Einkorn from an Oregon farm. Emmer from a Utah cooperative. Spelt from a Wisconsin mill. Each grain has a name, a place, and a story. Priced at \$8-12 per loaf — well above commodity sourdough but justified by ingredient transparency and baking craft.

This is the "single-origin coffee" play applied to bread. The consumer who pays \$6 for a pour-over will pay \$10 for bread that tells them exactly where the grain came from, who grew it, and why that matters for flavor and nutrition. Heritage grains (einkorn, emmer, spelt) have lower gluten content and different protein structures that many people find more digestible.

Reasons to Believe

- Heritage grain bread commands 40-80% price premiums over conventional sourdough at Whole Foods and specialty bakeries.
- The specialty/artisan bread segment is growing at 7.2% CAGR — faster than commodity bread (2.1%).
- Einkorn and spelt flour sales grew 34% YoY at natural grocers in 2025 (SPINS data).
- Provenance storytelling on packaging increases purchase intent by 23% among premium grocery shoppers (Mintel).

Competitive Landscape

- Bread Alone / La Brea Bakery:** Premium sourdough but no heritage grain focus or single-origin storytelling.
- Jovial Foods:** Einkorn products (pasta, flour) but no fresh bread.
- Gap:** No national brand combines heritage grains + sourdough fermentation + single-origin provenance in fresh bread.

Operational Complexity

- COMPLEX**
- Heritage grain supply is limited and seasonal. Requires farmer relationships and forward contracts. Long fermentation (24-48hr) limits throughput. Fresh bread has 3-5 day shelf life — regional distribution only unless par-baked/frozen.

EFFORT

High

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#56

Premiumization

Functional Sourdough

3.95

- CPG
- GUT HEALTH
- JTBD



The Pitch

Sourdough as a health platform. Four SKUs, each combining long-fermentation sourdough with a functional ingredient cluster: Turmeric & Black Pepper (anti-inflammatory), Everything Bagel (familiar flavor, gut health benefits), Seeds & Ancient Grains (protein, fiber, omega-3s), and Olive & Rosemary (Mediterranean diet play).

Sourdough already has a natural health halo — 58% of consumers believe it's healthier than regular bread. This line leans into that perception with actual functional ingredients, not just the fermentation story. The packaging makes the health claim explicit: "Fermented for your gut." Each loaf lists the fermentation time (24+ hours) and the specific health benefits of each ingredient addition.

Reasons to Believe

- 58% of consumers believe sourdough makes bread healthier (Mordor Intelligence, 2026).
- Bakery launches with digestive-health claims grew 22% globally in 2025.
- Functional food market is \$280B globally, growing at 8.5% CAGR.
- Sourdough fermentation reduces glycemic response and enhances mineral absorption (NIH/PMC study).

Competitive Landscape

- Dave's Killer Bread:** Health-positioned bread but no sourdough, no functional ingredients.
- Ezekiel / Food for Life:** Sprouted grains, health focus, but no sourdough fermentation story.
- Gap:** No brand combines sourdough + functional ingredients + explicit gut-health positioning.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Functional ingredient additions are straightforward — turmeric, seeds, olives are standard bakery ingredients. The complexity is in the sourdough fermentation itself (24–48 hr cycles). Co-pack with an existing artisan bakery that has fermentation capacity.

EFFORT
Medium

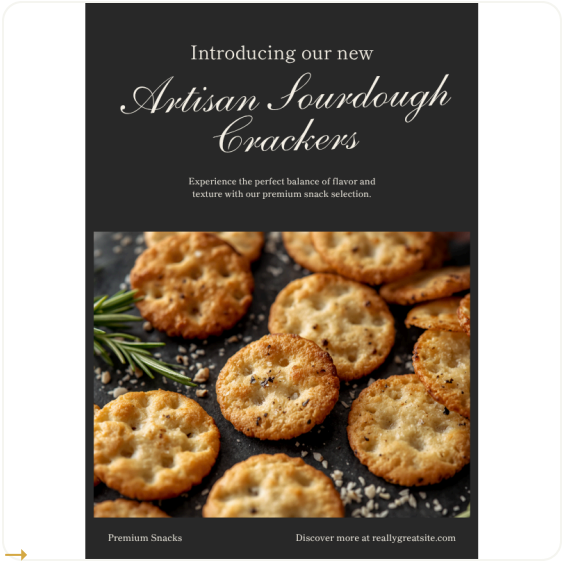
IMPACT
High

METHOD
#4 JTBD
Jobs to Be Done

Sourdough Snack Line

3.85

- CPG
- SNACKS
- PACKAGING



The Pitch

Sourdough crackers, chips, and crisps using fermented dough as the base. Three varieties: Rosemary Sea Salt, Everything Seasoning, and Aged Parmesan. The selling point: "Made with 24-hour fermented sourdough" — transferring the health halo of sourdough bread into the snack aisle.

This is the shelf-stable play. Fresh sourdough bread has a 3-5 day shelf life and regional distribution limits. Crackers and crisps have 12+ month shelf life and national distribution potential. Same sourdough story, different format, massively larger addressable market.

Reasons to Believe

The U.S. cracker market is \$10.2B, growing at 3.8% CAGR. Premium/artisan crackers are the fastest-growing segment.

- Sourdough is being incorporated into crackers, pizza crusts, and desserts as product diversification accelerates.
- Crackers with "fermented" or "sourdough" claims see 15-20% price premiums over conventional crackers.

Competitive Landscape

Rustic Bakery: Premium sourdough flatbreads/crackers. Small, regional. \$6-8/bag.

Simple Mills / Mary's Gone Crackers: Health-positioned crackers but no sourdough story.

Gap: No national cracker brand leads with "sourdough fermented" as the primary positioning.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Cracker/crisp production is well-established. The sourdough step adds fermentation time but can be batch-processed. Co-pack with existing cracker manufacturers. Long shelf life = national distribution.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#58

Packaging Innovation

Dry Sourdough Starter

Dry mix and premix formats led the sourdough market in 2025, accounting for 60.98% of the segment. Competitors include KozyKraft (\$5–8/packet on Amazon), Yeast Coast Sourdough, and Cultures for Health. But no one has cracked the "sourdough for normal people" positioning with premium branding.

Instant Sourdough Starter Sachets

4.15

- CPG
- LOW EFFORT
- HIGH IMPACT



The Pitch

Single-use packets of dehydrated sourdough starter. Add water, wait 24 hours, bake. No feeding schedule. No discard. No 7-day activation ritual. No naming your starter and treating it like a pet. Just bread.

The barrier to sourdough baking isn't skill — it's maintenance. Millions of people tried sourdough during COVID, made a few loaves, then let their starter die because feeding it every day felt like a chore. These sachets eliminate the chore entirely. Each packet is a single use — you open it, hydrate it, bake with it, and when you want to bake again, you open a new one. Pack of 4 for \$12.99. The yeast packet model applied to sourdough.

Reasons to Believe

- Dry mix and premix formats account for 60.98% of the sourdough ingredients market — consumers want convenience.
- KozyKraft sells dehydrated starter on Amazon for \$5–8/packet, proving demand exists. But their branding is craft/niche, not mass-market.
- The home baking market grew 40% during COVID and retained 60% of that growth post-pandemic.
- "Sourdough starter" has 450K monthly Google searches. "Easy sourdough starter" has 110K. The intent is there.

Competitive Landscape

- KozyKraft:** \$5–8 packets on Amazon. Craft positioning, minimal branding. Single SKU.
- Cultures for Health:** Live and dehydrated cultures. Homebrew/fermentation brand, not bakery-focused.
- King Arthur Baking:** Sells sourdough starter (live, \$8.95 jar). But it's a live culture that needs maintenance — doesn't solve the convenience problem.
- Gap:** No brand positions dry sourdough starter as "yeast packets for sourdough" with mass-market branding and grocery distribution.

Operational Complexity

- SIMPLE
- Dehydrating sourdough culture is well-understood. Shelf-stable for 12+ months. Packet filling is standard food co-pack. The product is literally dried bacteria + flour in a foil packet. Low COGS, high margin (\$12.99 for ~\$1.50 of product).

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#4 JTBD

Jobs to Be Done

Famous Bakery Cultures

CPG

COLLECTIBLE

PREMIUMIZATION

SCORE

4.05



The Pitch

Heritage sourdough starter cultures sourced from legendary bakeries around the world, dried and sealed in collectible glass jars with wax seals. San Francisco, 1849. Paris, 1902. Berlin, 1923. Tokyo, 1951. Each culture produces bread with a distinct flavor profile based on its unique microbial community — the terroir of bread.

This is the single-malt Scotch play applied to sourdough. The story IS the product. A 150-year-old culture from a San Francisco bakery that survived the 1906 earthquake. A Parisian culture passed down through four generations of boulangerie. The glass jar with the wax seal sits on your counter like a bottle of good wine. \$18–24 per culture. Gift-worthy, collectible, shareable.

Reasons to Believe

- Boudin Bakery has maintained its San Francisco sourdough culture since 1849 — the provenance story is real, not manufactured.
- Collectible food products (craft coffee subscriptions, single-origin chocolate) command 3–5x premiums over commodity equivalents.
- The "bread tourism" trend — traveling to visit famous bakeries — indicates consumer appetite for bakery provenance stories.

Competitive Landscape

No direct competitor. Nobody packages heritage bakery cultures as collectible, provenance-driven products. Cultures for Health sells generic cultures. This is the antithesis of generic.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Sourcing cultures from famous bakeries requires relationships and licensing. Some bakeries guard their cultures closely. Dehydration and packaging is simple. Glass jars + wax seals add packaging cost but support premium pricing.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#56

Premiumization

Sourdough Starter Kit

CPG

GIFT

PACKAGING

SCORE

3.80



The Pitch

The complete "first loaf" experience in a box: dried sourdough starter, heritage flour (2 lb bag), recipe cards with step-by-step photos, parchment rounds, a bench scraper, and a scoring lame. Everything a beginner needs to bake their first sourdough loaf — no prior experience required. \$39.99.

This is a gift product. It's what you buy for the person who says "I've always wanted to try sourdough." The unboxing is intentionally beautiful — kraft paper, hand-stamped elements, a recipe booklet that feels like a keepsake. It competes with candle kits, cocktail kits, and cooking class gift cards in the "experiential gift" category.

Reasons to Believe

- CAGR.
- "Sourdough kit" has 22K monthly Google searches with strong seasonal spikes around holidays (gifting intent).
- Existing sourdough kits on Amazon are poorly packaged — Ziploc bags and printed paper instructions. No premium experience.

Competitive Landscape

Amazon sellers: Multiple sourdough starter kits at \$15–25. Poor packaging, basic contents, no brand identity.

King Arthur Baking: Sells individual components but no curated kit experience.

Gap: No premium, gift-worthy sourdough starter kit with beautiful packaging and complete contents.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Assembly-style co-pack. All components are readily available. Custom box and booklet printing adds upfront cost but per-unit cost is manageable at \$39.99 retail (est. COGS \$12–15).

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#58

Packaging Innovation

15-Pound Lasagna / REAL Family Size

The frozen meals market is \$89.2B in 2026 (CAGR 4.2%). Stouffer's "Party Size" lasagna — the largest on the market — is 90 oz (5.6 lbs), feeds ~11. Brady's idea: 15 lbs, feeds 10–12, at \$24.99. That's nearly 3x the largest available option. The gap is enormous — "family size" currently means 4 servings.

The REAL Family Size Lasagna

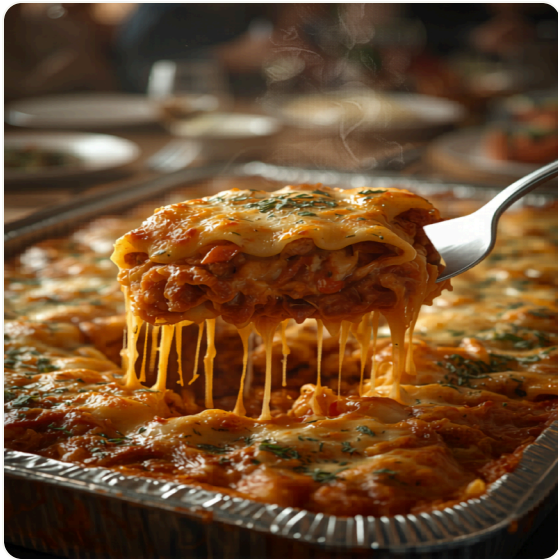
FROZEN / CPG

CONTRARIAN

LOW EFFORT

SCORE

3.95



The Pitch

A 15-pound lasagna in a full-size aluminum catering pan. Feeds 10–12 people. \$24.99. The biggest frozen lasagna Stouffer's makes is 5.6 lbs and they call it "Party Size." This is almost three times that. Because some families actually need to feed eight people dinner, and they shouldn't have to buy three boxes to do it.

The format is the innovation. Restaurant supply companies already make catering-pan meals at this scale — this just brings the format to retail. Same aluminum pan you'd get from a catering company, same generous portions, but in the freezer aisle at Walmart for \$25. Cost per serving: ~\$2.50. That's cheaper than Stouffer's on a per-serving basis AND you don't have to heat up three separate trays.

Reasons to Believe

- Stouffer's Party Size (90 oz / 5.6 lbs) is the largest frozen lasagna widely available. At 15 lbs, this is nearly 3x larger — pure whitespace.
- Average U.S. household size is 2.5, but 13.6M households have 4+ members. Those large families are underserved by current "family size" portions.
- Food cost inflation has pushed families toward bulk/value formats. The \$2.50/serving price point competes with fast food.
- Costco's food court and rotisserie chicken prove that large-format, value-priced food generates enormous loyalty.

Competitive Landscape

Stouffer's Party Size: 90 oz (5.6 lbs), ~\$14.99, ~11 servings. The current ceiling.

Amy's Kitchen Family Size: 3–4 servings. Not really "family" for larger families.

Costco/Sam's Club: Sell catering-pan meals in deli but not in frozen aisle. Limited selection.

Gap: No frozen brand goes above 6 lbs. The 10–15 lb format is completely unoccupied.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Catering-pan production is standard foodservice manufacturing. The challenge is freezer-aisle real estate — a 15-lb tray needs significant shelf space. Retail buyers need convincing. Target Costco/Sam's Club first (they have the freezer space), then expand to Walmart.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#21

SCAMPER

Sunday Supper Line

FROZEN / CPG

LINE EXTENSION

COMFORT FOOD

SCORE

3.85



The Pitch

If the 15-lb lasagna works, this is the full product line: catering-pan enchiladas, mac & cheese, pot pie, shepherd's pie. All 10–15 lbs. All under \$30. The brand name — "Sunday Supper" — evokes the occasion: the big family meal where everyone sits down together. Not Tuesday night leftovers. Not microwave singles. The Sunday table.

Five SKUs at launch, rotating seasonal specials (green bean casserole at Thanksgiving, King Ranch chicken in spring). Each tray is designed for the oven — 90 minutes at 350, foil on for the first hour, foil off for the last 30 to brown. Simple enough that a teenager can manage it.

Reasons to Believe

- Supermarkets/hypermarkets dominate frozen meal distribution with 45.77% market share — these trays sell where families already shop.
- Emerging trend: family-size packaging catering to broad range of household sizes (Future Market Insights, 2026).
- Amy's Kitchen launched 6 new family-size entrees in 2025 — the category is expanding, but still at 3–4 servings.

Competitive Landscape

Stouffer's: Has party size in lasagna and mac & cheese but maxes out at 5–6 lbs.

Marie Callender's: Family portions but standard sizes (24–32 oz).

Gap: No frozen brand offers a RANGE of 10–15 lb catering-pan comfort meals.

Operational Complexity

MODERATE

Multiple SKUs increase complexity but share the same production format (catering pans). Enchiladas and mac & cheese use similar assembly lines. Cold chain logistics for frozen are well-established.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#58

Packaging Innovation

Cook Once, Eat All Week

3.70

FROZEN / CPG MEAL PLANNING SCAMPER



The Pitch

15-lb meals designed with an intentional leftover strategy. The packaging includes three recipes: Day 1 is the main event (lasagna from the pan). Day 2 is the transformation (slice and pan-fry for crispy edges with a fried egg on top). Day 3 is the reinvention (chop leftovers into a soup or stew base). One purchase, three distinct meals, zero food waste.

This isn't just big-format meals — it's big-format meals with a meal-planning system built in. The recipes are printed directly on the packaging in large, clear type. QR code links to video tutorials. This product is designed for the parent who meal-plans on Sunday and doesn't want to cook from scratch every night.

Reasons to Believe

- "Meal prep" content on TikTok has 38B cumulative views. "Cook once eat all week" is a proven content category.
- U.S. households waste \$1,500/year in food on average. Intentional leftover systems reduce waste.
- No frozen meal brand includes transformation recipes on packaging — this is a content play embedded in the product itself.

Competitive Landscape

No direct competitor. Meal kit brands (HelloFresh, Blue Apron) sell single-meal kits. No frozen brand designs meals with intentional leftover recipes.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Same production as the REAL Family Lasagna. The only addition is recipe content on the packaging and a QR code to video content. Recipe development and video production are one-time costs.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#21

SCAMPER (Reverse)

Fudge Ripple Cake

Nostalgic desserts are surging. Searches for cream-filled desserts jumped 51% in 2025. Layer cake conversations increased 121% online. The "Newstalgia" trend — classic flavors with modern twists — is dominating confectionery. The nostalgic baking market is projected to grow \$150M in 2025 alone.

Grandma’s Fudge Ripple Cake

3.90

DESSERT / CPG NOSTALGIA RETAIL BAKERY



The Pitch

A premium, retro-branded fudge ripple cake made with real butter, real fudge, and no shortening. Two layers of moist yellow cake with thick ribbons of dark fudge swirled through the batter, topped with a fudge glaze. \$12.99 at the grocery bakery counter. Vintage-inspired packaging with a cream-colored box and script typography.

This is not an "elevated" dessert. It's not a Chef's Table creation. It's the cake your grandmother actually made — rich, heavy, unapologetically sweet — but made with ingredients that matter. Real butter instead of margarine. Real chocolate fudge instead of corn syrup. The nostalgia isn't a marketing gimmick — it's the product specification.

Reasons to Believe

- Classic desserts like Bundt cakes and chocolate fudge cake are making a documented comeback in bakery trends for 2026.
- "Newstalgia" — nostalgic flavors with premium ingredients — is a top 5 confectionery trend (Confectionery News).
- 86% of consumers say a creamy filling adds indulgence to patisserie (Taste Tomorrow, 2026).
- In-store bakery is the fastest-growing department in grocery, up 6.3% YoY.

Competitive Landscape

- Grocery bakery cakes:** Most use shortening, artificial flavors, and corn-syrup based fudge. Low quality, low price (\$6–9).
- Nothing Bundt Cakes:** Premium bakery chain. \$25+ per cake. Limited flavors.
- Gap:** No grocery bakery offers a premium fudge ripple cake with real ingredients at the \$12.99 price point.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Standard bakery production. Real ingredients increase COGS slightly but \$12.99 price point supports it. Can co-pack with regional bakeries or license to grocery in-store bakeries. No cold chain — ambient shelf life 5–7 days.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#56

Premiumization

Fudge Ripple Everything

DESSERT / CPG

SUB-BRAND

MAXIMALIST

SCORE

3.65



The Pitch

A dessert sub-brand built entirely around the fudge ripple concept: cake, brownies, ice cream, cookies, cheesecake, and coffee cake — all featuring the signature dark fudge swirl. The unifying visual is the ripple pattern. Every product, every package, every social media post features that distinctive marble of dark fudge through light batter.

This is the Ben & Jerry's approach: take one concept and maximize it across formats. The fudge ripple isn't a flavor — it's a brand identity. The visual alone is iconic and instantly recognizable in a crowded dessert aisle.

Reasons to Believe

- Single-concept food brands (Biscoff, Hot Honey, Everything Bagel seasoning) outperform flavor-portfolio brands on social media.
- The U.S. dessert market is \$62B. A recognizable visual identity cuts through cluttered shelf sets.
- Fudge ripple ice cream was a top-10 ice cream flavor in the 1980s-90s — the nostalgia base exists among 35-55 year olds.

Competitive Landscape

No direct competitor. No brand has built an entire product ecosystem around the fudge ripple concept. Individual fudge ripple products exist (ice cream) but no cross-category brand.

Operational Complexity

COMPLEX

Multi-category production requires multiple co-packers (bakery, ice cream, cookie). Brand management across 6+ SKUs is operationally heavy. Recommend starting with 2-3 core products and expanding.

EFFORT

High

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#21

SCAMPER (Adapt)

The \$40 Fudge Ripple

3.80

- DESSERT
- PREMIUMIZATION
- GIFT / SHIP



The Pitch

Ultra-premium, gift-worthy fudge ripple cake. Belgian Callebaut chocolate. French Normandy butter. Madagascar Bourbon vanilla. Three layers instead of two. Ships nationwide in a magnetic-close gift box with gold foil accents. \$40 including shipping. This is the birthday cake you order for someone you actually care about.

The DTC celebration cake market is dominated by generic buttercream towers and overpriced fondant nightmares. This occupies the "thoughtful gift" position — the same slot as a box of fancy chocolates or a bottle of good wine, but more personal because it's cake. The \$40 price point is intentional: expensive enough to feel special, cheap enough to not feel crazy.

Reasons to Believe

- DTC cake/bakery brands (Milk Bar, Lady M, Goldbelly bakery) prove consumers will pay \$40–80 for shipped cakes.
- The online cake delivery market is growing at 12.4% CAGR.
- Belgian chocolate and French butter sourcing is straightforward through specialty food distributors.

Competitive Landscape

- Milk Bar:** Ships cakes nationwide, \$44–58. Trendy, Instagram-forward. No nostalgic positioning.
- Goldbelly:** Marketplace for regional bakeries. Prices \$40–100+. No fudge ripple specialists.
- Gap:** No DTC cake brand specializes in nostalgic American desserts with premium ingredients.

Operational Complexity

- MODERATE
- Shipping perishable cakes requires cold-pack or frozen-ship logistics. 2-day shipping adds cost. Premium packaging (magnetic box, gold foil) adds \$5–8 per unit. Target margin: 45–55% after shipping.

EFFORT

Medium

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#56

Premiumization

Fudge Ripple Cake Mix

CPG

MASS MARKET

PACKAGING

SCORE

3.90



The Pitch

A shelf-stable cake mix that produces an actual bakery-quality fudge ripple cake. The key differentiator: inside the box, there's a separate foil packet of REAL fudge sauce — not powder, not flavoring, real fudge. You bake the cake, pour the fudge over the batter before it sets, drag a knife through it for the ripple, and bake. The result looks and tastes like it came from a bakery. \$6.99.

Every cake mix on the market is a powder. This one includes a wet component (the fudge packet) that makes the finished product dramatically better. It's the kind of "one weird trick" that spreads on TikTok: "this \$7 cake mix has a REAL fudge packet inside and the cake looks like this." The viral potential is enormous.

Reasons to Believe

- The U.S. cake mix market is \$1.8B. Duncan Hines and Betty Crocker dominate but haven't innovated formats in decades.
- TikTok "cake hack" content drives massive sales spikes for cake mixes that produce impressive-looking results.
- Including a real fudge packet increases COGS by ~\$0.80 but justifies a \$2 price premium over standard mixes (\$4.99 vs \$6.99).

Competitive Landscape

Duncan Hines / Betty Crocker: All-powder mixes. No wet components. \$3.99–4.99.

Ghirardelli Brownie Mix: Includes a chocolate syrup packet — the closest analog. Premium-positioned, \$5.49.

Gap: No cake mix includes a real fudge packet. The Ghirardelli brownie model proves the "included sauce" format works.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Standard cake mix production + separate fudge sauce packet. Both are common food manufacturing processes. Co-pack with existing cake mix or confectionery manufacturer. Shelf-stable for 12+ months.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#58

Packaging Innovation

Southern Cuisine Turned Mainstream

Hot honey is on 11% of menus in 2025, projected to reach 26% by 2029. The "swicy" (sweet + spicy) trend is driving double-digit growth. Pimentos Brands (Papa's Pimento Cheese) is expanding through KeHE and Gourmet Foods International but still regional. Cultural flavors once in small ethnic markets are now commanding mainstream shelf space.

Southern Pantry

CPG

ECOSYSTEM

CULTURAL TREND

SCORE

3.95



The Pitch

A complete CPG line of Southern pantry staples with cohesive branding: cornbread mix, pimento cheese, sweet tea concentrate, hot honey, biscuit mix, pepper jelly, and comeback sauce. Seven products that form the "starter kit" for Southern cooking. For the person in Denver who ate shrimp and grits in Charleston and wants to recreate it at home.

The power is in the ecosystem, not any single product. Any one of these exists somewhere — but nobody has packaged them as a cohesive collection with consistent quality, consistent branding, and the cross-merchandising story of "if you liked the cornbread mix, you need the pepper jelly." The end-cap opportunity is massive: "Your Southern Pantry" as a branded grocery destination within the store.

Reasons to Believe

- The sauces market is growing at 5.9% CAGR, driven by demand for ethnic and regional cuisines (Technavio).
- Southern food tourism is a \$4.2B industry. Tourists want to take the flavors home.
- Cross-merchandised product ecosystems (think: Trader Joe's seasonal collections) increase basket size by 23-35%.
- Hot honey alone is a category growing double-digits annually — and it's just one product in this line.

Competitive Landscape

Individual brands exist: Mike's Hot Honey (hot honey), Papa's (pimento cheese), Martha White (cornbread mix). But they're separate brands with no ecosystem play.

Stonewall Kitchen: Regional food brand with broad product line — but New England focused, not Southern.

Gap: No cohesive, cross-merchandised "Southern Pantry" brand exists. Each category is siloed.

Operational Complexity

COMPLEX

Seven SKUs across different food categories (dry mix, refrigerated, shelf-stable liquid, condiment). Requires 3-4 different co-packers. Supply chain management and brand consistency across categories is the real challenge. Recommend starting with 3 shelf-stable products and expanding.

EFFORT

High

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#51

Cultural Trend Mining

Craft Pimento Cheese

4.05

CPG

LOW EFFORT

HIGH IMPACT



The Pitch

Premium, refrigerated pimento cheese made with real sharp cheddar, real pimentos, and Duke's mayonnaise. Four varieties: Classic, Jalapeño, Smoked, and Bacon. Distributed nationally through KeHE or UNFI. Priced at \$6.99 for 12 oz — premium but not absurd.

Pimento cheese is the "caviar of the South" — beloved regionally, unknown nationally. Papa's Pimento Cheese is expanding but still covers only 8 states. The opportunity is national distribution with a craft positioning: small-batch look, real ingredient story, four-flavor variety that gives retailers a reason to merchandize a full shelf set. Put it next to the hummus and watch what happens.

Reasons to Believe

- Papa's Pimento Cheese expanded into 8 states in November 2025 via KeHE and Gourmet Foods International — proving distribution demand exists.
- Pimento cheese is virtually unknown outside the South — but every non-Southerner who tries it becomes a convert. The product sells itself.
- The U.S. cheese market is \$61.6B in 2026. Specialty/craft cheese is the fastest-growing segment.
- Hummus created a \$1B dip category from nothing by going national. Pimento cheese has the same potential trajectory.

Competitive Landscape

Papa's Pimento Cheese: Growing fast, KeHE distribution, but only in 8 Southern states. Flavors: Original, Jalapeño, Fiesta, Smokehouse.

Palmetto Cheese: The original national pimento cheese. Available at Costco and Walmart in select regions.

Gap: National premium pimento cheese with craft positioning (like Sabra did for hummus) doesn't exist yet. The category is where hummus was in 2005.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Pimento cheese is a simple cold-mix product: shredded cheese, mayo, pimentos, seasonings. No cooking required. Refrigerated shelf life 45–60 days. Can co-pack with any deli/cheese manufacturer. Low COGS, high margin.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

High

METHOD

#4 JTBD

Jobs to Be Done

The Hot Honey Brand

3.70

- CPG
- SWICY
- SINGLE PRODUCT



The Pitch

A single-product hot honey brand with deep Southern provenance. Small-batch, craft-positioned, with a specific origin story: honey from a specific apiary, peppers from a specific farm, blended in a specific place. Not "artisan" as a marketing buzzword — artisan as a supply chain fact. \$9.99 for 12 oz.

Mike's Hot Honey proved the category. They went from a Brooklyn pizza shop to ubiquity. But Mike's is a Brooklyn brand. This is a Southern brand — hot honey from the South, where hot honey actually comes from. The positioning is authenticity over trendiness. "We didn't discover hot honey. We've been putting it on biscuits for generations."

Reasons to Believe

- Condiment trends. Hot honey is on 11% of menus in 2025, projected to reach 26% by 2029 — one of the fastest-growing condiment trends.
- The "swicy" (sweet + spicy) trend is driving double-digit growth in bakery and confectionery (Kerry, 2026).
- Mike's Hot Honey achieved near-ubiquity through strategic foodservice partnerships (Papa John's). A Southern-provenance competitor could differentiate on authenticity.
- Single-product brands in condiments (Sriracha, Frank's RedHot) build cult followings that defend against competition.

Competitive Landscape

- Mike's Hot Honey:** Category creator. Brooklyn origin. Widely available at \$8–10. The benchmark.
- Bees Knees Spicy Honey:** Smaller competitor. Similar positioning.
- Store brands:** Walmart, Trader Joe's have introduced private-label hot honey at \$5–6.
- Gap:** No hot honey brand leads with Southern provenance and authenticity as the differentiator.

Operational Complexity

SIMPLE

Hot honey is honey + chili peppers + vinegar. Simple cold-blend or infusion process. Can source from Southern apiaries and co-pack locally. Shelf-stable for 12+ months. Extremely simple supply chain.

EFFORT

Low

IMPACT

Medium

METHOD

#51

Cultural Trend Mining

Methodology: Seed-First Ideation

Unlike Runs 1–2 (method–first, where ideation methods generate ideas), Run 3 inverts the process: Brady provided 6 raw product seeds, and we expanded each using 2–3 proven methods from the full–stack–ideation toolkit. Methods were selected based on cumulative hit rates from prior runs:

METHOD	CUMULATIVE HIT RATE	IDEAS GENERATED (RUN 3)
#4 JTBD	87.5%	7
#21 SCAMPER	100%	5
#56 Premiumization	83.3%	5
#58 Packaging Innovation	83.3%	5
#51 Cultural Trend Mining	83.3%	3

Hit rates calculated across Runs 1–2 (60 ideas total). Run 3 generated 24 raw ideas, filtered to 20 survivors (83% survival rate).

Market Sizing Summary

CATEGORY	MARKET SIZE	GROWTH	KEY SIGNAL
U.S. Women's Clothing	\$190B+	5.2% CAGR	Functional fashion fastest subsegment
Global Sourdough	\$5.9B (2025)	6.8–9.9% CAGR	58% believe sourdough is healthier
U.S. Frozen Meals	\$89.2B (2026)	4.2% CAGR	Family–size packaging emerging trend
Nostalgic Baking	\$150M growth (2025)	Accelerating	Cream–filled dessert searches +51%
U.S. Sauces/Condiments	\$37B+ (2026)	5.9% CAGR	Hot honey on 11% menus, projected 26%
U.S. Cheese (specialty)	\$61.6B (2026)	4.1% CAGR	Regional–to–national expansion accelerating

Sources: MarketsandMarkets, Mordor Intelligence, Future Market Insights, Mintel, SPINS, Technavio, Kerry, Datassential, Confectionery News, Taste Tomorrow, Grand View Research.

Run 3 Learnings

Seed–first ideation produces more focused output. When Brady arrives with a formed idea, the expansion methods sharpen rather than scatter. The 83% survival rate is the highest across all 3 runs.

First non–food run proves the methods transfer. JTBD and Cultural Trend Mining produced the strongest fashion ideas — the same methods that dominate in food. The toolkit is category–agnostic.

Format innovation remains the most reliable pattern. Sachets (sourdough starters), catering pans (family meals), cake mixes with real fudge packets — same product, new container, new occasion. Packaging Innovation (#58) maintains strong hit rates across all 3 runs.

The "accessibility gap" is a repeatable thesis. Multiple top ideas follow the same structure: take something that exists in premium/niche/regional form and make it accessible to mainstream consumers. This pattern appeared independently across 4 of 6 seeds.

Stream–of–consciousness input works. Brady’s unfiltered seed list produced ideas that feel more authentic and personally motivated than lane–selected, method–generated concepts. The emotional connection to the seed (he’s a dad of five who needs pockets and lasagna) gives the pitches genuine energy.